

Week 1 - Introduction to Business Analytics

Lesson Plan:

Business Analyst Role — 5-Week Lesson Plan

Total duration: 30 hours (5 weeks × 6 hours/week) **Format:** Each week = 6 hours, split into two 3-hour sessions (or one 6-hour session, whichever suits the group) **Audience:** Beginners to intermediate learners aiming to work as, or transition into, a Business Analyst (BA) role

Learning Outcomes (by end of course)

Learners will be able to:

1. Explain the BA role, its place in a project team, and core responsibilities
2. Elicit, document, and manage business and functional requirements
3. Use industry-standard tools (JIRA, Confluence, Excel, Visio/Lucidchart, SQL basics)
4. Model processes using BPMN and UML basics
5. Write user stories, use cases, and acceptance criteria
6. Support Agile/Scrum ceremonies and stakeholder management
7. Produce a complete BA deliverable package for a mock project

WEEK 1 — Introduction to the BA Role & Foundational Tools

Goal: Understand what a BA does, where they sit in an organization, and set up the core toolkit.

Session 1 (3 hours) — The Role

Time	Topic
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0:00–0:30	Welcome, course overview, expectations
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- 0:30–1:15 What is a Business Analyst? Role definition, BABOK overview, BA vs Product Owner vs Project Manager
- 1:15–1:30 Break
- 1:30–2:15 Where BAs sit: SDLC, Agile vs Waterfall, industries that hire BAs
- 2:15–3:00 Core BA competencies: communication, analytical thinking, documentation, facilitation

Session 2 (3 hours) — Tooling Setup

- | Time | Topic |
|-------------|---|
| 0:00–0:45 | Overview of the BA toolkit: JIRA, Confluence, MS Excel, Visio/Lucidchart, PowerPoint, SQL |
| 0:45–1:30 | Hands-on: Setting up JIRA — projects, boards, issue types, workflows |
| 1:30–1:45 | Break |
| 1:45–2:30 | Hands-on: Confluence — documentation spaces, linking to JIRA |
| 2:30–3:00 | Homework brief: mock project (e.g., "Online Bookstore Revamp") assigned for the course |

Deliverable: Personal JIRA + Confluence workspace set up; role summary one-pager written by learner.

WEEK 2 — Requirements Elicitation & Documentation

Goal: Learn how to gather, structure, and validate requirements.

Session 1 (3 hours) — Elicitation Techniques

- | Time | Topic |
|-------------|--|
| 0:00–0:40 | Elicitation techniques: interviews, workshops, surveys, observation, document analysis |

- 0:40–1:20 Stakeholder identification and RACI matrix
- 1:20–1:35 Break
- 1:35–2:20 Practice: Mock stakeholder interview (role play)
- 2:20–3:00 Writing effective interview questions and probing techniques

Session 2 (3 hours) — Documenting Requirements

Time	Topic
0:00–0:45	Business Requirements Document (BRD) vs Functional Requirements Document (FRD)
0:45–1:30	Writing SMART requirements; avoiding ambiguity
1:30–1:45	Break
1:45–2:30	Hands-on: Draft a BRD section in Confluence for the mock project
2:30–3:00	Peer review exercise: critique a sample BRD

Deliverable: Draft BRD (2–3 pages) for the mock project, stored in Confluence.

WEEK 3 — Process Modeling & Data Basics

Goal: Visually model processes and understand data structures well enough to work with technical teams.

Session 1 (3 hours) — Process Modeling

Time	Topic
0:00–0:40	Introduction to BPMN: events, gateways, swimlanes
0:40–1:30	Hands-on: Build an "As-Is" process diagram in Lucidchart/Visio
1:30–1:45	Break

1:45–2:30 Hands-on: Build a "To-Be" process diagram (improved process)

2:30–3:00 Gap analysis: comparing As-Is vs To-Be

Session 2 (3 hours) — Data & SQL Fundamentals

Time	Topic
0:00–0:40	Why BAs need basic SQL; relational database concepts (tables, keys, relationships)
0:40–1:30	Hands-on: SELECT, WHERE, JOIN, GROUP BY (using a sample database)
1:30–1:45	Break
1:45–2:30	Reading a simple ER diagram / data dictionary
2:30–3:00	Practice: Write 5 SQL queries against mock project data

Deliverable: As-Is/To-Be BPMN diagrams + 5 working SQL queries.

WEEK 4 — User Stories, Use Cases & Agile Ceremonies

Goal: Translate requirements into Agile artifacts and understand the BA's role in Scrum.

Session 1 (3 hours) — User Stories & Use Cases

Time	Topic
0:00–0:40	User story format: "As a... I want... so that..."
0:40–1:20	Writing acceptance criteria (Given/When/Then — Gherkin style)
1:20–1:35	Break
1:35–2:20	Use case diagrams and use case descriptions (actors, flows, exceptions)
2:20–3:00	Hands-on: Write 5 user stories + acceptance criteria in JIRA for the mock project

Session 2 (3 hours) — Agile & Scrum for BAs

Time	Topic
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0:00–0:40	Scrum framework: roles, ceremonies, artifacts
0:40–1:20	The BA's role in backlog grooming, sprint planning, and sprint review
1:20–1:35	Break
1:35–2:20	Prioritization techniques: MoSCoW, Kano model
2:20–3:00	Hands-on: Prioritize and groom the mock project backlog in JIRA

Deliverable: Groomed JIRA backlog with 8–10 prioritized user stories and acceptance criteria.

WEEK 5 — Stakeholder Management, Reporting & Capstone

Goal: Consolidate skills into a professional BA deliverable package and present it.

Session 1 (3 hours) — Stakeholder Management & Reporting

Time	Topic
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0:00–0:40	Managing conflicting stakeholder needs; communication planning
0:40–1:20	Building dashboards/status reports in Excel/PowerPoint
1:20–1:35	Break
1:35–2:20	Change management basics: handling scope creep, change requests
2:20–3:00	Hands-on: Build a one-page project status report for the mock project

Session 2 (3 hours) — Capstone Presentation

Time	Topic
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0:00–1:00	Final work time: assemble full BA deliverable package (BRD, BPMN diagrams, backlog, status report)
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1:00–1:15 Break

1:15–2:30 Learner presentations (5–10 min each): walk through the mock project as if presenting to stakeholders

2:30–3:00 Feedback, course wrap-up, career guidance (resume tips, interview prep, portfolio building)

Final Deliverable (Capstone Package):

1. Business Requirements Document (BRD)
2. As-Is / To-Be BPMN process diagrams
3. Prioritized JIRA backlog with user stories & acceptance criteria
4. Sample SQL queries against mock data
5. One-page stakeholder status report
6. 5–10 minute presentation

Tools Summary (used across the course)

Tool	Purpose
JIRA	Backlog management, user stories, sprint tracking
Confluence	Requirements documentation, knowledge base
MS Excel	Data analysis, tracking, reporting
Visio / Lucidchart	Process modeling (BPMN), use case diagrams
SQL (any RDBMS, e.g. SQLite/MySQL)	Data querying and validation
PowerPoint	Stakeholder presentations

Suggested Pre-Reading / References

- BABOK Guide (Business Analysis Body of Knowledge) — overview chapters

- "Software Requirements" by Karl Wieggers (selected chapters)
- Scrum Guide (scrumguides.org)

Assessment Approach

- Weekly deliverables (40%)
- Participation in role plays/workshops (10%)
- Final capstone package (35%)
- Final presentation (15%)

Note: Session timings assume a 15-minute break per 3-hour block; adjust to fit institutional scheduling norms. Content can be delivered in-person, virtually, or hybrid, with hands-on tool segments recorded for asynchronous review.

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